

1. Medha Kudaisiya's paper delved into a period that is of exceptional importance in the history of the Indian planning process. It recounted the experience of economic planning in India in the late 1960s, a time of vigorous contestation over ideas, instruments and choices of economic paradigms. These were critical years in terms of the political transition which India experienced. The rich historical documents presented by the author lucidly described the tensions that were playing out with regard to the appropriate approach to planning. It examined the contestations which raged in different *fora* –within academic circles, especially amongst economists, in political circles, in the press and amongst bureaucrats. It also took a look at how planning became a contested area between the Centre and states and at the endeavors to decentralize economic planning, especially in its financial aspects. The author contended that by the end of this period and with the removal of D.R. Gadgil from the position of the Deputy Chairman of the Planning Commission, a political approach to planning reigned over a scientific and technocratic approach

Chairing the session, Dr Nasir Tyabji observed that this was an important contribution for the insights it provided into to how the accumulation regime faltered after the mid1960s, , with a change in emphasis from planning for accumulation to planning for regional resource allocation. Also, how the Congress tried to incorporate the political aspirations of assertive regional entrepreneurial interests, which first expressed themselves in the 1967 election, by including them within "Congress factionalism." He wished the author had drawn out the larger issues of political economy from the extended anecdotal discourse around planning.

As the discussant, Dr. Arindam Banerjee felt that the period dealt by the author is of immense significance not only for whatever happened to the planning process during this time but also due to the tumultuous conditions and uncertainties in the economy. The fact that the Five-year Plans were suspended during this short period is also linked to the larger stress generated by slow growth rates and emerging food shortages in the economy. The Green Revolution strategy, which went on to become a grand success in raising food output, was launched largely in the wake of these food shortages, more driven by vulnerability than by any well-thought out plan. The new accumulation in agriculture also led to the spontaneous rise of rural capitalist farmers, who formed an important political lobby in the country since this period.

The contestation of ideas and approaches within the planning process Dr Banerjee argued emanated out of these complex and volatile political economy factors in this short phase of